Bosnia.'[15] Once there, he stressed the need to convert Bosnian Muslims to Lashkar's interpretation of Islam. To this end he urged the same types of dawa-related activities Lashkar practiced in Pakistan:

> We have to strengthen our Belief and the Belief of our Brethren the Bosnians by *all* means: through training, through education, through awareness programs and other means.[16]

He also believed that the Bosnian conflict presented the jihadi movement with an opportunity to 'make Islam enter Europe via jihad' according to an interview he gave to Lashkar's *Al-Dawa* magazine.[17] Jamal al-Fadl, a government informant and former member of al-Qaeda, reaffirmed this, testifying that Bahaziq stated a main objective of the Bosnian jihad was 'to establish a base for operations in Europe.'[18] The primary aim was to spread Bahaziq's (and Lashkar's) interpretation of the Salafi faith among Muslims in Europe and to develop a support base among them. To be sure, this included an emphasis on jihad, but the intent at the time was not to stake out terrain from which to begin launching terrorist attacks against the West.

While these peripatetic forays helped the group to begin weaving together the fabric of its transnational networks, it was the Kashmir jihad closer to home that enabled Lashkar to grow into the robust organization it is today. Some of Lashkar's militants began fighting in Indian-administered Kashmir as early as 1990. Before long other fronts were closing and Kashmir had become among the most active theaters for militants seeking to liberate occupied Muslim land. Many of the Pakistani jihadi groups that fought in Afghanistan against the Soviets began sending militants to Indian-administered Kashmir, where indigenous outfits were already active. The ISI was sponsoring a number of groups there, and Lashkar was not the first, second or even the third group the state threw its weight behind. General Javed Ashraf Qazi (Retd) was the Director-General of the ISI from 1993–1995, when the state began investing heavily in Lashkar. He described it as a 'very motivated group,' but also 'a very small one that was only just coming up.'[19] Ironically, it was the group's small size and weak position in Pakistan that contributed to its burgeoning relationship with the state. Because Lashkar was an Ahl-e-Hadith group and estranged from the wider Ahl-e-Hadith movement, it did not have a significant support base in